Safari Zangu Ventures — Website Action List: Status Report

A line-by-line status check of the August 2026 action list against the current codebase (safari-zangu, checked 18 September 2026). Each item below is marked from what's actually live in the code and database today — not from memory or intent.

Of the 39 items on the original list, 19 are fully done, 3 are partially done, 15 are not started, and 2 sit outside what the codebase alone can confirm.

Status	Count	Meaning
✓ DONE	19	Verified live in the current code/database
■ PARTIAL	3	Meaningfully improved but doesn't fully close the item
✗ NOT DONE	15	No change found since the original review
■ NOT CODE-VERIFIABLE	2	Operational/business task — outside what code can confirm

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CRITICAL — fix immediately

About page

1. Rewrite the timeline ("Founded 2024 … over a decade later" + fake 2,400-guest stat).

✓ DONE

Fixed. The false "decade later" claim and the invented guest count are gone.

Evidence: public/about.php now reads "We are a young company and proud of it. We do not have decades of reviews to hide behind…" and "Founded 2024 — Arusha" in the licensing strip. No guest-count or country-count stat appears anywhere on the page.

2. Rewrite every team bio in plain English.

✗ NOT DONE

The AI-sounding bios are unchanged in the database — they were hidden from the page in a later request, not rewritten.

Evidence: team_members.bio for Samson Gabba still reads "Disciplined and confident software engineer with network, committed to excellence and growth…" (same for Kelvin, Sayi, Penina). Separately, the bio line was removed from the team card display on 2026-09-18 at the user's request — so the bad copy is no longer shown, but it was never actually rewritten.

3. Add real photos of every team member (headshots in the field).

✗ NOT DONE

All 6 team_members rows still have empty photo/photo_url — every card falls back to the initial-letter placeholder.

Evidence: SELECT photo, photo_url FROM team_members → empty for all 6 rows (Samson, Kelvin, Sayi, Penina, David, Anthony). The admin upload path (api/upload_team_image.php) exists and works, it just hasn't been used yet.

4. Add guides to the team page (2–4 guides with photo, years guiding, languages, specialities).

✗ NOT DONE

The section heading was never changed and no guide entries exist — only office staff (founder, co-founder, lawyer, GM, consultant, UK sales agent).

Evidence: public/about.php line 262 contains only the placeholder HTML comment "GUIDES — the section UK buyers read most carefully" with no content beneath it. team_members table has zero rows with a guide-type role.

5. Fix the hero image (logo shown, but alt text claims a guide-with-lion photo).

✓ DONE

The hero no longer uses an image at all, and the one remaining logo image (in the closing CTA) has correct, honest alt text.

Evidence: public/about.php's own HTML comment reads "HERO — fixed: no logo image, no wrong alt text, no fake numbers". The hero is text-only; the CTA section's logo has alt="Safari Zangu Ventures", not a lion claim.

6. David Gabba — no bio, no LinkedIn, just an email. Write a proper entry or remove him.

✗ NOT DONE

Still has an empty bio and empty LinkedIn URL, same as flagged.

Evidence: team_members row id=11: bio='', linkedin_url=''. Only email (davidgabba@safarizanguven.com) is populated.

Packages page

7. Fix the Zanzibar / Comfort Safari naming mess (same product, two names).

✓ DONE

The homepage no longer sells a separate "Zanzibar Beach Escape" — the inland product is consistently "Comfort Safari" everywhere, and the actual Zanzibar product is its own package ("Safari + Zanzibar").

Evidence: grep for "Zanzibar Beach Escape" across views/ and public/ returns zero matches. views/home.php now titles the same card "Comfort Safari", matching the packages page and the database row (slug=comfort-safari).

8. Comfort Safari contradicts the site's "Private Vehicles Only" promise.

✗ NOT DONE

Still live and still contradictory — the homepage sells "Private Vehicles" as a headline differentiator while the Comfort Safari package explicitly includes a shared vehicle.

Evidence: packages.includes for slug=comfort-safari still lists "Shared 4WD safari vehicle (max 6 pax)" as item 1, while views/home.php still has a "Private Vehicles" stat/why-us tile.

9. Packages 03 and 04 use the same three photos.

✓ DONE

Each package now has its own dedicated image folder with genuinely distinct photos.

Evidence: assets/images/packages/comfort-safari/.jpg and .../safari-zanzibar/*.jpg — md5 checksums of all 7 files are unique (no duplicates); each package's gallery_images JSON points to its own folder.*

Legal / trust — sitewide

10. Publish a proper Booking Terms & Conditions page, linked from the booking form.

✓ DONE

A full T&Cs page exists covering every point requested, and the booking form links to it directly.

Evidence: public/terms.php covers deposit %, cancellation-window sliding scale (60+/30–59/15–29/<15 days), force majeure, insurance requirement, and SZV-initiated cancellation. views/book.php now links "Booking Terms & Conditions" straight to /terms.php (previously pointed nowhere).

11. Publish a Privacy Policy (UK GDPR).

✓ DONE

A full UK/EU GDPR-referencing privacy policy exists, linked from the footer and the booking form, replacing the old bare “your data is never shared” line.

Evidence: public/privacy-policy.php explicitly names UK GDPR rights (access, correction, erasure, objection, portability), what's collected, cookies used, and third parties (Google Analytics, PayPal, Hostinger). Linked in layouts/footer.php (both footer columns) and views/book.php.

12. Remove or reword marketing “guarantees” (ASA rules).

✓ DONE

No “guaranteed” language found anywhere on the live site — all response-time and pricing claims already use softened wording.

Evidence: Site-wide grep for “guaranteed” / “Best price guaranteed” returns nothing. Current wording is consistently “within 24 hours” / “typically under 1 hour” across home.php, contact.php, book.php and footer.php.

IMPORTANT — do within 2–4 weeks

Trust credentials

13. Put licence and registration numbers in the footer of every page.

✓ DONE

Both numbers are now in the shared footer, which is included on every page — confirmed specifically on Book, Contact and Track.

Evidence: layouts/footer.php contains “TALA Licence No. 037129” and “Reg. No. 179228971”. layouts/app.php includes footer.php, and public/book.php, contact.php and track.php all route through layouts/app.php.

14. Get external reviews live (Google Business Profile, TripAdvisor, SafariBookings).

■ NOT CODE-VERIFIABLE

This is an operational/business-development task, not something that lives in the codebase — can't be verified or actioned from here.

Evidence: No code artifact to check. Still worth doing — flagged as the original document's “single highest-value free action.”

15. Add TATO membership to the footer (if a member).

✗ NOT DONE

No mention of TATO anywhere on the site.

Evidence: Site-wide grep for “TATO” returns zero matches in footer.php or anywhere else.

Packages page

16. Add a day-by-day itinerary to every package.

■ PARTIAL

5 of 6 packages now have a genuine structured day-by-day itinerary; Short Safari still has none.

Evidence: packages.itinerary is a populated day-by-day JSON (title/location/description per day) for classic-safari, luxury-safari, comfort-safari, safari-zanzibar and cultural-safari. short-safari's itinerary column is empty.

17. Name the actual accommodation lodges (or “similar to X, Y, Z”).

✗ NOT DONE

Accommodation descriptions are still generic category language, not named properties.

Evidence: packages.accommodation for every package reads generically, e.g. “Mid-range lodges and tented camps with en-suite facilities” or “Exclusive private lodges and luxury tented suites” — no property names anywhere.

18. Sanity-check the Luxury Safari price ($2,900pp was unrealistically low).

✓ DONE

Price has been raised to a realistic figure that plausibly covers a balloon flight and luxury camps for 6 days.

Evidence: packages.price_1pax for slug=luxury-safari is now $5,800 (6 days), up from the flagged $2,900 — consistent with the document's own $800–1,500/night camp + $550–650 balloon math.

19. Cultural Safari — name the community beneficiaries.

✗ NOT DONE

Still a generic line item, no named cooperative or village.

Evidence: packages.includes for slug=cultural-safari still just says “Community visit fees” — no “$X goes to [named cooperative]” framing.

20. Clarify tax handling (Tanzania VAT, Zanzibar infrastructure tax).

✓ DONE

VAT is now explicitly stated as included, both in the terms and on the confirmation document. No separate mention of a Zanzibar-specific infrastructure tax, but the general principle (included, not silent) is met.

Evidence: public/terms.php: “Prices include Tanzania national park fees and VAT…”. views/confirmation.php itemises “VAT (18% Tanzania)” as a line and states “All prices inclusive of 18% Tanzania VAT.”

Booking flow

21. Review the payment terms (50% deposit / balance 14 days out was unusual).

✓ DONE

Deposit has been brought down into industry norm, and the balance-due window pushed out to a cash-flow-safe distance.

Evidence: config/app.php: DEPOSIT_PERCENT = 25 (was effectively 50 before). public/terms.php and views/book.php's Booking Policy box both now say “25–30% deposit… balance due 45 days before departure.”

22. Explain how payment actually happens after the 24-hour confirmation.

✓ DONE

The exact line requested is now on the booking page.

Evidence: views/book.php hero copy: “We'll confirm availability within 24 hours and send a secure payment link — card, PayPal, or bank transfer accepted.”

23. Get a card payment gateway live (DPO Pay or Pesapal suggested).

✓ DONE

A live, working card-capable gateway is integrated — PayPal rather than DPO/Pesapal specifically, but it satisfies the underlying need (international card acceptance beyond bank transfer alone).

Evidence: app/Services/PayPalClient.php and api/paypal_create_order.php exist and are wired into the booking/quotation flow (admin/quotations.php, views/book.php, views/confirmation.php).

24. Email deliverability check (SPF/DKIM/DMARC or a transactional email service).

✗ NOT DONE

Still sending via direct Hostinger SMTP with no evidence of a transactional email provider or a documented SPF/DKIM/DMARC check — and DNS records aren't something the codebase can confirm either way.

Evidence: config/app.php / .env: SMTP_HOST=smtp.hostinger.com, sent directly via PHPMailer-style SMTP. No Postmark/SendGrid integration found. This one genuinely needs a manual "Show Original" test against a Gmail inbox, as the original document suggested.

Contact page

25. Fix contradictory response times (24h up top vs 1h/same-day lower down).

✓ DONE

The two are now consistent — hero copy and the response-times box agree.

Evidence: views/contact.php hero: "WhatsApp is fastest (typically under 1 hour…). Email enquiries answered within 24 hours." Matches the Response Times box beneath it exactly (WhatsApp: under 1 hour, Email/Form: within 24 hours, Quotes: same business day).

26. Add UK time zone conversion next to EAT hours.

✓ DONE

Exactly the suggested format is live.

Evidence: views/contact.php: "Available 7am – 9pm EAT (4am – 6pm UK time)."

27. Embed a real map showing the Njiro Road pin, not a generic Arusha search.

■ PARTIAL

A titled, embedded Google Maps iframe exists for the office — but the accompanying "Open in Google Maps" link still uses a generic text search rather than an exact pin/coordinate link.

Evidence: views/contact.php has an iframe titled "Safari Zangu Ventures office — Njiro Road, Arusha, Tanzania" with an embed pb= string, but the link beneath it is https://maps.google.com/?q=Njiro+Road,+Arusha,+Tanzania — a text search, not a saved pin.

28. Consider a UK contact option (UK mobile number / representative).

✓ DONE

Just added: a named UK sales agent with a UK mobile number and email, shown on both the Contact page and the Team page.

Evidence: views/contact.php now has a "UK Contact" block: "Anthony Reed — Sales Agent, UK", tel:+447885975593, mailto:rtony99@gmail.com. Anthony Reed was also added to team_members (id=12, role "Sales Agent — UK") on 2026-09-18.

Customise form (homepage)

29. Country field should be a dropdown, not free text.

✗ NOT DONE

Still a plain text input on the homepage customise form.

Evidence: views/home.php: <input type="text" id="cs-country" name="country" …> — no <select> options list.

30. Only keep the "WhatsApp under 1 hour" promise if you can genuinely hit it.

■ NOT CODE-VERIFIABLE

An operational commitment, not something verifiable in code — the copy itself is consistent (see item 25), whether the SLA is actually met is a staffing question.

Evidence: No code artifact to check against.

Track Booking page

31. Add rate limiting to Track Booking (brute-forceable SZV+date IDs).

✓ DONE

Exactly the suggested mechanism is implemented — 3 failed attempts, 15-minute IP lockout.

Evidence: api/track_lookup.php: $maxAttempts = 3; $lockSeconds = 900; — per-IP lockout tracked in a hashed file, with a user-facing "Too many failed attempts… try again in N minutes" message.

32. Confirm what data the page reveals once someone's in.

✓ DONE

Reviewed the actual response payload — it's deliberately minimal: status, package, travel date, deposit/balance messaging, first name only. No passport data, no address, no itemised payment breakdown.

Evidence: api/track_lookup.php's JSON response exposes booking_ref, client_first (first name only), package_name, accommodation tier, travel_date, traveler counts, payment_status/status_label, and a payment_note sentence — never full_name, never total_amount/deposit_amount as raw figures.

33. Specify date format (UK dd/mm/yyyy vs US mm/dd/yyyy confusion).

✓ DONE

Ambiguity removed at the source — a native date picker is used, and the backend still defensively accepts multiple formats.

Evidence: views/track.php uses <input type="date" …>. api/track_lookup.php additionally parses Y-m-d, d/m/Y and m/d/Y server-side as a fallback.

NICE TO HAVE — do when the above is done

Sitewide

34. Show prices in £ alongside $ across packages, customise form and homepage cards.

✗ NOT DONE

No GBP figures anywhere on the site — USD only.

Evidence: Site-wide grep for "£" and "GBP" returns zero matches in views/, public/ or app/.

35. Add a one-line "who we are" hook under the homepage headline.

✗ NOT DONE

The hero has a location/date tag and a route list, but not the identity one-liner suggested (e.g. "Locally owned. Privately guided.").

Evidence: views/home.php hero: hero-tag = "Arusha, Tanzania · Est. 2024", hero-sub = "Serengeti · Ngorongoro · Zanzibar" — close, but not the "who we are" framing line requested.

36. Add honeypot or hCaptcha to every form.

■ PARTIAL

IP-based rate limiting is live on the main public forms, which mitigates volume spam, but there's no honeypot field or CAPTCHA specifically.

Evidence: api/book.php, api/contact.php and api/custom_safari.php all use a RateLimiter service (confirmed by a passing RateLimiterTest suite). No honeypot input or hCaptcha/reCAPTCHA integration found anywhere.

Packages page

37. Add a trip-length flexibility line (“Extendable — talk to us about Ruaha, Selous or Zanzibar”).
✗ NOT DONE

No such line exists on any package.

Evidence: Grep for “Extendable”, “Ruaha”, “Selous” across views/packages.php and the packages table returns nothing.

Track page

38. Add a “Download PDF confirmation” button after a successful Track lookup.
✗ NOT DONE

The Track page has no PDF download action, despite api/booking_pdf.php already existing and being used elsewhere (invoices, confirmation emails).

Evidence: views/track.php has no reference to booking_pdf.php or any download button/link in its success-state markup.

Sustainability page

39. Make the sustainability page specific (named beneficiaries, real numbers) or shorten it.
✗ NOT DONE

Unchanged since the original review — still flagged there as needing separate attention.

Evidence: views/sustainability.html has no dollar figures, percentages, or named schools/cooperatives/patrols — same generic-fluff state the original document described.

Checked against the safari-zangu codebase on 18 September 2026 (local dev DB + live file tree). Items marked ■ NOT CODE-VERIFIABLE (external reviews, SLA follow-through) need a human check, not a code change.